Jorge Paredes

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconometrics • Causal Inference • Time-Series and Nowcasting • Development Economics • Agricultural and Climate Economics • Political Economy

EDUCATION

Barcelona School of Economics **Barcelona, Spain**
MSc in Economics and Finance 09/2024 – 08/2025

- Degree awarded by Universitat Pompeu Fabra and Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona.
- Thesis: *The Social Fallout of Sovereign Default Risk in the LAC Region*. Advisors: Isaac Bailey, Ph.D., and Victoria Vanasco, Ph.D.

Universidad San Francisco de Quito (USFQ) **Quito, Ecuador**
BSc in Economics 08/2017 – 05/2021

- Thesis: *The Cleansing Effect in Emerging Markets: Evidence from Ecuador*. Advisor: Carlos Uribe, Ph.D.
- Dean's List (several semesters).

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Nudging the Agents: Does It Reduce Discrimination Against Migrants in the House Rental Market?" with W. Zanoni, L. Díaz, E. Díaz, and P. Acevedo. IDB Working Paper No. IDB-WP-1517, November 2023.
2. "Emerging Markets Bond Index Performance and Sovereign Default: The Case of Ecuador." with W. Zanoni, E. Díaz, L. Andrian, and J. L. Maldonado. IDB Working Paper No. IDB-WP-1569, March 2024.
3. "Exploring Gender Discrimination: A Multi-Trial Field Experiment in Urban Ecuador." with W. Zanoni and S. Duryea. SSRN Working Paper, December 2024.
4. "Assessing the Emissions Risks of Agricultural Support Policies: A Meta-Analytical Framework." with S. Guerrero and J. Ilicic. FAO Agricultural Development Economics Working Paper *(under editorial review)*.

Work in Progress

1. "Growth Interrupted: The Cost of Political Instability in Peru." with J. Beverinotti and W. Zanoni.
2. "The Climate Effects of Structural Reforms in Agricultural Support Systems." with S. Guerrero and J. Ilicic.
3. "Surviving the Storm: Exploring the Cleansing Effect and Firm Closures in Ecuador."
4. "Does Tracking Help? Regression Discontinuity Evidence from Chilean Schools."

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) **Rome, Italy**
Economist Intern, Agrifood Economics and Policy Division (ESA) 02/2026 – Present

- Developed NECTAR, a hierarchical state-space model that nowcasts sub-national maize yields in the United States from dekadal satellite and weather data, estimated by Kalman-filter maximum likelihood with analytic gradients.
- In collaboration with the ESTELLA geospatial team, built a Python and Earth Engine pipeline that clusters Zimbabwe's cropland into agroecological zones and estimates zone-level El Niño effects on rainfall, temperature, and vegetation with local projections, wild bootstrap, and randomization inference, deriving maize production scenarios for the 2026/27 season.
- Estimated how structural reforms of agricultural support affect emissions in a 62-economy panel, dating reforms as persistent shifts in support composition with Gaussian mixture models and estimating their effects with synthetic control, LP-DiD, and continuous difference-in-differences.
- Estimated mixed-effects probit, GEE, elastic net, and machine-learning classifiers with leave-one-study-out cross-validation on 197 emissions outcomes from 28 studies, and built an emissions risk index for 23 countries that weights each policy's estimated risk by its share of producer support.
- Designed and built a modular, reproducible R ETL pipeline integrating five international data sources (FAOSTAT, UN Comtrade, IMF, World Bank WDI, and GEM) into a harmonized cross-country panel of 24 developing countries (2000–2025) for MAFAP price-incentive monitoring, with rule-based frequency harmonization, provenance tracking, an automated coverage inventory, and an interactive Shiny dashboard.

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB) **Remotely**
External Consultant (PEC), Peru Country Office 09/2025 – 12/2025

- Built a quarterly cross-country panel on political instability and macroeconomic performance from V-Dem, World Bank, IMF, and national accounts sources, and designed a DBSCAN algorithm that detects instability episodes from clustered presidential turnovers.
- Estimated the growth cost of political instability in Peru with synthetic control (SCM, augmented SCM, SDID, and staggered SC) and single-treated-unit difference-in-differences (de Chaisemartin–D'Haultfœuille and LP-DiD), with in-space inference and a pre-registered specification plan.

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB) **Quito, Ecuador**
Research Assistant for Ecuador's Economics Senior Specialist 11/2022 – 12/2024

- Quantified discrimination in labor and real-estate markets in Ecuadorian and Colombian cities through field experiments and econometric analysis.
- Built a structural model with a Simulated Method of Moments (SMM) estimator to analyze taxpayer behavior around income-regime thresholds in Ecuador's tax system, under Prof. Juan Pantano.
- Implemented a synthetic control analysis estimating the impact of Ecuador's 2008 sovereign default on EMBI spreads and long-term sovereign risk.

Universidad San Francisco de Quito (USFQ) **Quito, Ecuador**
Research Assistant for Prof. Carlos Uribe, Ph.D. 06/2020 – 10/2022

- Developed R packages implementing a Factor-Augmented Vector Autoregression (FAVAR) model for inflation forecasting, and coded output-gap estimation functions for emerging markets, supporting an IDB consultancy led by Prof. Uribe.
- Assisted in grading, problem-set design, and exam development for Intermediate Macroeconomics, Computational Economics, and the Undergraduate Thesis Seminar.

Neo-Plan Cia. Ltda. **Quito, Ecuador**
Research Assistant 11/2020 – 11/2021

- Contributed to a feasibility study on establishing a dry port as an extension of Manta's port, assessing economic, logistical, and regulatory factors.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent, C1/C2), French (intermediate), Italian (basic), Portuguese (basic).
- **Technical:** R (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), Stata (advanced), Python (intermediate), Julia (intermediate), MATLAB (intermediate), Git/GitHub (intermediate), Microsoft Excel (intermediate).

REFERENCES

Carlos Uribe, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Economics, USFQ
cauribe@usfq.edu.ec

Joanna Ilicic, Ph.D.
Economist, Agrifood Economics and Policy Division, FAO
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Juan Pantano, Ph.D.
Associate Professor of Economics, HKU Business School, The University of Hong Kong
jpanta@hku.hk

Wladimir Zanoni, Ph.D.
Economics Senior Specialist, IDB Ecuador
wladimirz@iadb.org

Santiago Guerrero, Ph.D.
Environmental Externalities Specialist, Agrifood Economics and Policy Division, FAO
Santiago.GuerreroEscobar@fao.org

Pedro Romero, Ph.D.
Director of the Master in Economics and Associate Professor of Economics, USFQ
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